

Kapu

Much the same way that Western fae still cling to a medieval European past, the Menehune hold the kapu system sacred. The kapu system holds great magical significance to the Menehune. To break taboo not only brings harm to the breaker, but on all of the people.

Some taboos are enforced by the kahuna, while others are enforced by the gods. Even if a taboo breaker does not suffer an immediate penalty, it is always coming, and often affects those around the transgressor as well as the transgressor himself. To break one of Pele's taboos is to incur her wrath; she might not strike immediately, but she will eventually.

Kahuna are always aware if a Menehune, or truly any human or fae, has broken a taboo. The spirits whisper to her the penalty that is to be exacted, and the kahuna's word, once spoken, is law.

System: The Storyteller always decides the punishment that the spirits decree for a broken taboo. The kahuna may attempt to lessen the punishment, or increase it if she feels it is not harsh enough. To do this, the kahuna must spend from one to three Glamour (Storyteller's choice based on the degree of change) and make a Kenning roll (difficulty 7). A success is needed for each point of Glamour that was required to be spent.

The Shattering

The Shattering did not affect the Menehune in the same way as it did the European fae. The Hawai'ian islands were untouched by the black plague, the Inquisition, and the wars and strife that plagued Europe in the 14th century, so they remained untouched by the Banality that struck much of the rest of the world. The gateways and trods remained open longer, and even when they began to close the Menehune did not take notice. Life on the islands was all they desired, and they had long before distanced themselves from the politics of Arcadia. Even when the selkies arrived and brought word that the gates to the Dreaming had closed, many did not believe them. Who needed to return to Arcadia when the dreams here were full of life and love? Then came the arrival of Captain Cook. The first iron nail that was traded to a Hawai'ian mortal on Kaua'i changed everything.

The Arrival of Captain Cook

Captain Cook found the Hawai'ian islands, quite by accident, while in the Pacific searching for a passage between the Atlantic and Pacific oceans. He arrived at the island of Kaua'i and found the natives to be very helpful and friendly. After trading for food, he set off again in search of the northwest passage. Much of what he traded was iron: knives, nails, and

tools. The Menehune felt the change to their island paradise as the Hawai'ians' desire for this wondrous metal grew.

A year later, Cook and his crew returned, having failed to discover the northwest passage. This time he set anchor off the Kona Coast on the Big Island, where he was greeted as a god. Cook's second visit, and the resulting tragedy, has famously formed the basis of a fierce debate in anthropological circles to this day. Perhaps it was a coincidence that Cook returned to the islands at the beginning of the festival of Lono. According to Hawai'ian legend, the great god left the island long ago, vowing to return one day. The sight of Cook, arriving in his magnificent ship, convinced the Hawai'ians that he was the great god, returned just in time for his feast. The Menehune were suspicious and tried to warn the humans, but they were too excited by the arrival of their god come to life.

After months in the Arctic, Cook's crew was more than ready to partake of the paradise offered by the Hawai'ians. Despite Cook's orders otherwise, they took many natives to bed, infecting them with venereal diseases. They received love and joy, and unwittingly returned the favor with the gift of death and disease. (By the mid-1800s, only one-sixth of the native population remained.)

With his ship resupplied and his crew's morale restored, Cook set out toward home. Unfortunately, the ship's forearm snapped and he was forced to return to the Kona Coast. The Hawai'ians were not pleased by Lono's return in disgrace, defeated by the sea. They had given so much of their food and resources to him that his swift return, with demands for more, did not seem right. The Menehune watched from afar, fearing the worst.

The Hawai'ians had come to covet the iron that came from the sailors, and they wanted more. Angered by the return of their god, they felt justified in stealing more iron whenever they got the chance. This led to a confrontation between Cook and his sailors and the Hawai'ians. Cook was struck down, and as he lay groaning on the beach, the people saw that he was not a god. Immediately, many Hawai'ians fell upon him and clubbed him to death.

The retaliation of Cook's crew was swift and brutal. They razed villages and killed many people. Finally, the chiefs agreed to return Cook's remains to the crew. His bones had been divided amongst the chiefs, as was done with the remains of all powerful people, since the bones were believed to contain much mana. With their captain's remains returned, the ship left harbor with the crew in a state of shock.

After Cook's arrival, the islands were never the same. Iron had come to the paradise of the Menehune, and along with iron came disbelief in the gods. Seeing Cook, whom they believed to be their god Lono, struck down, had a ripple effect on the people of Hawai'i, and the Menehune began to feel the first chills of Banality.

King Kamehameha

Kamehameha, a young warrior at the time of Cook's arrival, dreamed of uniting all of a Hawai'i into one unified kingdom. His ambition served him well, and he quickly rose in power